Teacher copy. It has answers and notes. Do not hand this out.

Walking on Ancient Ground: Detective Hunt Log Book questions

Name: _____ **Class:** _____ **Date:** _____

These questions go with the book's Detective Hunt Log Book. They ask students to check sources, notice silences and say how sure they are.

Before you read: sources

1. Who wrote each of the five fragments, and who did they write it for?

2. Which fragments were written at the time? Which were written later?

3. What does "redacted" mean? Who might remove a name from a record?

The Resistor

4. The book says the Resistor is "archetypal". What is an archetype, and why might a writer use one instead of a named person?

5. Which parts of the Resistor's story match the records? Which do not?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

6. The records call him a "murderer" and an "enemy". Whose words are those? What other words could describe him?

Thomas Freeman

7. Freeman's choices lead to different ends. Which choice would you make, and why?

8. Tench wrote that he asked Phillip to change an order. What does that tell you about Tench? What does it not tell you?

9. If a person in a story is not named in the records you have found, does that mean he did not exist?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

Thomas Curtis

10. Why did the Curtis family leave England? Which records support the book's reasons?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

11. The book gives Warra no words. What can a story tell us about a person who has no words, and what can it not tell us?

12. What would you want to ask Warra? Who is the right person to answer?

Comparing records

13. Pick one clash from the Board. Which side do you trust more, and why?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure **1** **2** **3** **4** **5**

14. Why is it important to keep what a story says apart from what the records say?

15. Whose voices are missing from the records you have seen? How could you find out more safely?

Spot the Discrepancy: questions for the whole class

Cases: 1. The march with no fight · 2. When was "last December"? · 3. How many days on the Andromache? · 4. When was the Sirius wrecked?

16. Pick one case. Which source is closer to the event, and does that make it more reliable?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure **1** **2** **3** **4** **5**

17. In which case is the difference most likely a choice by the writer, and what in the evidence tells you?

18. In which case could the record itself be wrong? What would you check to find out?

How sure am I? Circle one: 1 = not sure at all, 5 = very sure (1) (2) (3) (4) (5)

19. Choose a case that stays open. What source would you look for next?

Writing task: a source check

About 20 minutes. Aim for 150 to 250 words in total.

1. Choose one clash from the Board.
2. Name the source in the book, and the record you compared it with.
3. Say what the two agree on and what they do not.
4. Say what is still missing, and who could fill the gap.

Sentence starters: The book says… · The record says… · They agree that… · They do not agree that… · I trust ____ more because… · I would want to know…

The book says…

The record says…

Where they agree and where they do not

What is still missing

Teacher notes

- There is no single answer key for the discussion questions. The book does not give one answer, and neither does this app. The plot endings, the Resistor's identity and what the records show are behind the "Show answers" toggles, which are closed until you open them.
- Spot the Discrepancy shows students how historians compare sources. See the teacher note on that page and in Class mode.
- The book asks teachers to supplement the story with Indigenous voices and scholarship. Please follow your school's protocols, and consider inviting a local Aboriginal education worker or Elder.
- The story and the records include killing and the removal of children. Preview the Resistor, Freeman and Board pages before class, and offer students the choice to stop.
- Nothing students type leaves their device. Printing is the way to share work.

How historians compare sources

- Spot the Discrepancy shows students how historians compare sources. A historian puts two accounts side by side, asks who wrote each one and when, and asks whether the writer could have known. Then the historian says which reason best fits the evidence, and says plainly when the evidence cannot settle it.
- There is no answer key. Each case ends with what the evidence points to and what is still open. When you mark, look for a reason that is backed by something in the quotes, not for a match with the app's reading.
- The book is historical fiction, and the story is allowed to differ from the record. A difference is not a mistake by itself. The activity asks students to tell a story choice from a slip or a counting error.
- The four cases are marked as still being checked with the author. The app has not changed the book.

Spot the Discrepancy: what the evidence points to

The march with no fight

Most likely reasons: The author added a witness so readers could see it happen

The book is historical fiction. Its front pages say some dialogue and personal thoughts have been imagined. Straight after the spear, the story gives the reader a choice of what to do, so the fight is part of how the pick-a-path story works. The app marks this scene “From the story”.

Tench led the march and wrote about it. His account has no fight, no spear thrown and no clerk. The app has found no other account that records a fight on this march.

The evidence points to a story choice. Nothing found suggests that Tench made an error, but the app has read only his printed account, so it cannot say that nothing else happened that was not written down.

Still open: The app has not looked for other accounts of the march, such as journals of other men in the party.

When was “last December”?

Most likely reasons: The writer made a slip or remembered it wrongly; The author added a witness so readers could see it happen

If the march is “tomorrow” and the march was on 14 December 1790, then “earlier this year” fits the March wreck. But the spearing was only days before the march, in the same month, so “last December” does not fit.

If the chapter is set in 1791, “last December” would fit December 1790. But then “earlier this year” does not fit a wreck in March 1790, and the march of 14 December 1790 would not be “tomorrow”. No single year makes all three clues fit the records.

This could be a slip in the wording, or the story may have moved events closer together or further apart on purpose. The app’s Board notes that the story joins events from several different years into one time.

Still open: Only the author can say which it is. The app cannot tell a slip from a choice here.

How many days on the Andromache?

Most likely reasons: Someone copied or counted wrongly; The record could be wrong

In this case the book and the list agree. Both say 113 days. The mismatch is inside the list, between its "113 day passage" and its own two dates, which are 117 days apart.

This looks like a counting or copying error, either in the list or in the source it came from. But the app cannot rule out that the 113 days were counted from a different starting day. The list says the ship collected passengers at Plymouth and does not give the day she left there. Counting back 113 days from 24 June gives 3 March 1840, four days after 28 February.

The evidence does not show which explanation is right. It does show that the book has copied a number that does not match the dates beside it.

Still open: The page is a transcription. The original shipping records have not been checked, so the app cannot say where the difference began.

When was the Sirius wrecked?

Most likely reasons: The writer made a slip or remembered it wrongly; Someone copied or counted wrongly; Good sources disagree with each other

The two sources differ by a month. Tench's date is 19 February and the Sirius page gives 19 March 1790.

There is a clue inside Tench's own book. He says the Sirius sailed on 6 March, so a wreck on 19 February would be before she left. He also says he knew Norfolk Island only from what others told him, and that he learned of the wreck at Sydney.

These clues point to an error in Tench's date. It could be his slip, a mistake in an edition, or a mistake in the text the app used. The app cannot tell which.

Still open: The app has not checked an original printing of Tench or the journals of Hunter and Bradley, and has not found a source that explains how historians settle this date. So the sources differ, and 19 March is the date used in this app.

The Resistor: what the records show

The book does not say who the Resistor is. It says the figure is inspired by a documented Bidjigal leader of the 1790s, and that it does not claim to speak for clans or living cultural traditions.

What the records support: a Bidjigal man from the Botany Bay area was named by Colbee and others to Tench in December 1790 as the man who speared the Governor's gamekeeper. Tench spelled his name "Pimelwi". The National Museum, the Australian Dictionary of Biography and the Dictionary of Sydney name him Pemulwuy. Raids at Prospect and Toongabbie, wounds and an escape in 1797, and a death in 1802 are recorded. The book's Resistor shares the gamekeeper, the Prospect raids, the wounds and the belief that he cannot be shot.

Later records: the Darug believed firearms could not kill him after 1797. On 1 May 1801 Governor King ordered that Aboriginal people near Parramatta, the Georges River and Prospect could be shot on sight. In November 1801 Pemulwuy was outlawed and rewards were offered. He was shot dead on or just before 2 June 1802, and the National Museum says it is not certain who shot him. A later dispatch from London said that cruelty toward First Nations people would be punished.

What does not match: the order of events (the story joins 1790, 1792 and 1797 into one time), the soldiers' belief in 1790, Freeman on the march and at Prospect, the fight on the march, and the details of the night raid. Those are the story's.

What the records cannot tell us: why the gamekeeper was speared in the words of the people involved, what the Bidjigal people said about the raids, and what Warra thought. Almost every record was written by the colony's officers, who were fighting him. Item E is the only fragment from another point of view, and its speaker and place are not known.

So the case stays open. A careful finding says what the sources show, what the story adds, and what is missing. If your finding does that, it fits the book's own rule: do not invent facts that cannot be supported by primary evidence.

Still being checked with the author

- Freeman's chapter says the gamekeeper was speared "last December" but also says the march with Tench is "tomorrow". The records put both in December 1790, and the book's plates are dated December 1790.
- The Sirius was wrecked on 19 March 1790 in the Sirius sources. The Project Gutenberg text of Tench gives "19th of February". The original should be checked.
- The book says the flour was mouldy and weevil-filled. Tench wrote that the Cape flour was good. Other sources have not been checked.
- No clerk is listed in Tench's party. The march, the spear and the order to fire are written for the story.
- The records put the first raid at Prospect in May 1792. Freeman's chapter already says the Resistor leads raids and burns crops.
- The records say the Darug believed he could not be shot after his escapes in the 1790s. The book says the soldiers believed it in 1790.
- The records say terra nullius became law in 1835. The book uses the words for 1788.
- Curtis's ship, the stop at Port Phillip and August 1840 match a shipping list. The list also has a Margaret aged 18, and ages that may be wrong. The certificates have not been opened.
- The first record of the Andover bone crushing found is from 1845. The book has villagers talking about it before 1840.
- The RBA puts the severe drought in 1838 to 1840. The book's chapter has the river shrinking by 1842.
- For the author and Gadigal and Wangal sources: the clan names for the Cooks River and the word "Ngurra".

- Whether to name the Bidjigal leader in this app. The book does not. The app names him only after a reader locks in a finding, and in the closed teacher box. Tench's own account, the book's reading list and the National Museum page name him. The book's other companion app avoids names of Aboriginal people who have died, so this is the author's choice.
- The book's plates are labelled facsimile reconstructions. This app does not reuse them.
- The app uses the book's printed page numbers (the flipbook's page counter runs differently).